

THE *Adventure* OF LIVING WITH JESUS

A Guide to Discovering Your New Life



You Are a
New Creation



You Are
Never Alone



You Can Walk
with Confidence



You Have a
Clear Path Forward



You Belong to
God's Family

JesusOnline Ministries

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Begin the Adventure

Something real has begun in your life.

When you asked Jesus Christ to come in, you stepped into a personal relationship with God that will never end. The One who created you now lives within you, and Jesus promises to take you as you are and make your life extraordinary, Christ-centered, and purposeful.

It is the beginning of a new way of living—with Jesus Himself as your leader.

My Heart, Christ's Home

Many years ago, Robert Boyd Munger described what it felt like when he first invited Jesus into his life. He pictured his heart as a home, and Jesus as the welcomed guest who began to settle in:

“One evening I invited Jesus Christ into my heart. What an entrance He made! It was not a spectacular, emotional thing, but very real. Something happened at the very center of my life. He came into the darkness of my heart and turned on the light. He built a fire on the hearth and banished the chill. He started music where there had been stillness, and He filled the emptiness with His own loving, wonderful fellowship.”

Munger then imagined Jesus walking through each “room”—his thoughts, his desires, his relationships, his work, his free time, even the private places he felt ashamed to open to anyone. In every room, Jesus offered to bring light, order, and life.

Munger’s story illustrates how Jesus will transform your life inside out as you surrender every area of your life to Him and let Him be in charge of it. This booklet shows you how to begin this adventure with Jesus as you learn to let Him change you to become all God created you to be so that you can do all that He created you to do.

Walking the Path Ahead

The Christian life is more like a marathon than a sprint. There will be days of clarity and days of confusion, moments of triumph and moments of defeat. Ordinary days and spectacular events. What remains constant is the presence of Christ and the patient work of His Spirit within you.

He has already given you everything you need to take this journey.

What You Will Discover

This booklet is a guide for your new life in Christ. In the lessons ahead, you will explore:

1. **Citizen of Heaven** — the assurance of your eternal belonging and secure future with God
2. **Your New Identity in Christ** — who you truly are now that you belong to Him
3. **The Holy Spirit – Your Constant Companion** — the power and presence of God living in you
4. **Walking by Faith, Not by Feelings** — how to trust God in every situation
5. **God’s Word – Your Road Map** — the Bible shows a reliable path for your steps
6. **Prayer – Your Ongoing Conversation with God** — learning to talk with your heavenly Father
7. **Belonging to God’s Family** — the strength and joy of life with other believers
8. **Living a Life of Purpose** — how God sees your new life from His eternal purpose

Each lesson includes Bible verses, thoughtful questions, and space to respond. Move at a pace that allows the truth to settle in your mind and heart. Look up the verses. Speak honestly with God as you go.

The goal is not merely to finish these pages but to begin living the everyday adventure of walking with Jesus.

He is already with you. Your journey awaits.

Are you ready to take the next step?

1. Citizen of Heaven

Are you certain you would go to Heaven if you died today?

The Bible tells us we can know for sure.

Even after inviting Jesus into your life, you may still wonder. This section is written to give you clear, biblical confidence that you belong to Christ—now and always.

God's Free Gift

Jesus Christ paid the full price for all your sins on the cross. Through His death and resurrection, you have been given direct access to God. God's perfect justice has been completely satisfied by the blood of Jesus. He has purchased you—and there are no returns (Hebrews 7:25; 9:12).

Because this gift is so complete, a natural question often arises: "What about the good things I have done? Don't they somehow contribute?"

The Bible answers this question with clarity. Read the following verses carefully and write what each one reveals about who is responsible for your salvation:

Romans 5:8

Ephesians 2:8-9

Titus 3:5-6

1 Peter 3:18

Eternal life is a gift from God. You cannot do anything to earn it.

However, like any gift, you can choose to accept or reject it. It's your free choice

How to Join God's Family

Q: According to 1 John 5:11-13, and John 3:15-18, what is the one requirement of having eternal life in heaven?

In the original Greek language, the word “believe” means to trust in, cling to, and rely upon. In other words, “believe” in the original Greek language is an active faith—much like the faith rock climbers have in the rope to hold them secure. Becoming a Christian means placing that kind of trust in Jesus: relying fully on His death for your sins and His resurrection for your eternal life.

Faith versus Feelings

Christianity is a relationship with Christ—based on faith alone! Your faith is to be based on the facts in the Bible ... not feelings (See 2 Timothy 3:16). Faith in Christ may result in feelings ... and often does. But emotions are unpredictable and unreliable, and you can't depend upon them. Therefore, it is essential to rely on what God communicates in His Word, the Bible!

Where Are You Going After You Die?

Q: Read 1 John 5:11-13. If you have Jesus Christ in your life, what are you sure of?

Q: Once you have put your faith in Christ, is there anything that can separate you from God's love? What does Romans 8:38-39 tell us?

Q: Will Christ ever leave you? What does Hebrews 13:5 have to say?

Q: For how long will God forgive your sins? Read Hebrews 8:12.

As God's child, He will always love you—even when you fail Him. He will never give up on you—even when you give up on Him. Keep walking with Him.

Your Faithful Friend

The Bible tells you that Jesus is the friend who remains closer than any other. He is loyal, present, and unchanging—someone who will never leave or forsake you.

Ashley's Story

"I always put my friends above God. In fact, my life revolved around my friends so much that I began to get involved in reckless behavior just to seem 'cool' to others.

"Pretty soon I got involved in drugs, sex and alcohol. My life got out of control, and I felt worthless, with no purpose other than to get 'high.' Then I even lost my friends, who called me 'trash.'

"One day someone told me that Jesus Christ not only created me, but wanted to be my best friend. I couldn't believe it at first. Later, I decided to invite Him into my life. Since then, God has given me a new purpose in life and helped me break my addictions. I now have many new friends, but the greatest of all is Jesus Christ. He accepts me for who I am, and tells me that 'He will never leave or forsake me'" (Hebrews 13:5).

Ashley discovered what millions of others have discovered about Jesus: He is our best friend. No other friend loves you so much or will stick with you so closely (Proverbs 18:24). Jesus is totally loyal and faithful (Proverbs 20:6).

Growth is God's Plan for You

God does not leave you to figure out the Christian life on your own. From the beginning, He has a clear path for your growth:

1. Walk in the Holy Spirit
2. Trust God with your life
3. Know and trust God's Word
4. Talk with God in prayer
5. Connect with other believers
6. Live a life of purpose

These are not requirements to earn His love. They are the natural ways a new life in Christ begins to take shape. As you move through the rest of this booklet, look up the verses, respond honestly, and ask God to form these patterns in you. He is already committed to the work He has begun.

Go Deeper

Assurance of Your Salvation

2. Your Identity in Christ

The moment you trusted Christ, your identity changed forever. You are no longer defined by your past, your performance, or the opinions of others. You are now a child of God, with a new nature and a secure place in His family.

C. S. Lewis points out, “Mere morality is not the end of life. You were made for something quite different from that... The idea of reaching ‘a good life’ without Christ is based on a double error. Firstly, we cannot do it; and secondly... we have missed the very point of our existence.”

Lewis explains that the point of our existence centers on the tremendous inheritance we have in Christ as His children. Living for Christ is not our duty as His slaves, but our privilege as His sons and daughters.

Your Inheritance in Christ

As a Christian, you have been given a remarkable inheritance. Take time to read the following verses and thank God for what is now true of you:

- Your sins are completely forgiven (Colossians 2:13-14)
- You become a child of God—forever (John 1:12)
- Christ actually comes into your life (Revelation 3:20)
- The Holy Spirit is your guarantee (2 Corinthians 1:22)
- Christ gives you His nature (2 Corinthians 5:17)

A New You

“Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come: The old has gone, the new is here!” (2 Corinthians 5:17)

You are now a completely new creation—like a butterfly that was once a caterpillar. You may not always feel new or act new, but in God’s eyes you are fully new. The Father sees you as the one His Son purchased with His own blood. You are His royal child (Hebrews 2:9-11).

The apostle Peter describes believers as living stones being built into a spiritual temple, with Jesus as the cornerstone:

“And now God is building you, as living stones into His spiritual temple ... You are a chosen people. You are a kingdom of priests, God’s holy nation, His very own possession” (1 Peter 2:5, 9).

God says wonderful things about you. In Christ you are:

- Living Stones in His Spiritual Temple
- A Chosen People
- A Kingdom of Priests
- His Very Own Possession
- Citizens of God’s Holy Nation

It does not matter what your background, abilities, appearance, or status may be. You now belong to Christ’s body with believers from every time and place. You are a full citizen of heaven (Ephesians 2:19).

Your thoughts:

More like Christ

God’s plan is to conform you into Christ’s image (Romans 8:29). Jesus’ Spirit living in you has begun this change, and He will continue his work throughout your life (Philippians 1:6).

Q: Whose work is it according to Philippians 2:13?

Q: What qualities do you most value in a close relationship?

Go Deeper

Embracing Your New Identity in Christ

3. The Holy Spirit — Your Constant Companion

Ready in Heart, but Not Yet Empowered

The disciples were deeply moved after the resurrection and eager to follow Jesus wherever He led. Yet even after three years of walking with Him, they still lacked the power to live the life He had called them to live. Enthusiasm alone would not be enough.

Jesus knew they needed more. He told them, “You will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you” (Acts 1:8). Before leaving, He instructed them to wait for the promise of the Father: “I will send the Holy Spirit, just as my Father promised” (Luke 24:49, NLT).

The Holy Spirit is given many names in Scripture, yet His primary work in your life is to be your Encourager and Comforter as you walk with Christ (John 16:7-15). Without Him, living for Christ is impossible. With Him, you can do all things through the strength He supplies (Philippians 4:13).

The Indwelling Holy Spirit

When you invited Jesus Christ to be your Savior and Lord, He entered your life through the Holy Spirit—and He will remain with you forever. You are never alone.

Ephesians 3:16-17 says that God strengthens you with power through His Spirit in your inner being, so that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith. As Robert Munger pictured it, Jesus desires to settle into every “room” of your life, bringing light, warmth, and life. Christ lives in you by His Spirit.

Who Is the Holy Spirit?

Though invisible, the Holy Spirit is a real Person—the Spirit of Jesus (John 14:16-21).

Read the following verses and note what they reveal about Him:

Q: Acts 5:3-4

Q: John 14:16-17

Q: 1 Corinthians 6:19

The Bible makes clear that the Holy Spirit is fully God—one with the Father and the Son. As you yield areas of your life to Him, He brings purpose and meaning. The process is gradual and will include setbacks, yet “the one who began a good work in you will perfect it until the day of Christ Jesus.” (Philippians 1:6, NASB).

The Battle Within

Every day, you face influences from within and from the world about you that are pulling you away from God and going against His will—temptations, anger, addictions, jealousy, dissensions, hostilities, and other destructive behavior (Galatians 5:19-21). Even good things such as family, success, and security can come between God and you when they become the center of your life. True satisfaction comes only when you give Jesus His rightful place: the “throne” of your life (Matthew 6:33).

The apostle Paul writes about the struggle to live for Christ. In Romans 7, Paul writes about his desire to live for Christ but his repeated failures. He learned that this battle of his flesh (sinful nature) versus the Spirit can only be won when we surrender our wills to the Holy Spirit. Paul explains in Romans 8 how he achieved victory through the Holy Spirit.

As long as we live in this body, the conflict between self-centered desires and Christ’s way will remain. The question is which voice we will follow.

Q: What does Galatians 5:16-18 say about this inner conflict?

Q: According to Galatians 5:16-23, contrast the two ways of living:

The Self-Directed Life

The Spirit-Directed Life

The Filling of the Holy Spirit

Scripture says, “Live by the Spirit and you will not carry out the desires of the flesh” (Galatians 5:16, NASB). To be “filled” with the Spirit means to be directed and controlled by Him. A basketball player willingly places himself under the coach’s direction in order to play well and win the game. In the same way, we freely choose to place ourselves under the Spirit’s leadership.

Q: What does Ephesians 5:18 instruct us to do?

A New Way of Living

God's purpose is to conform you to the image of Christ (Romans 8:29). This lifelong process is the work of the Holy Spirit as you give Him control moment by moment. There is tremendous freedom in giving control over to Him. You will no longer be imprisoned by self-centered cravings and passions.

The diagrams below illustrate two ways a Christian can live. In one, self remains on the throne. In the other, Christ is given His rightful place. The difference is not in whether a person has received Christ, but in who is allowed to direct daily life.



The motivation for yielding control is not duty or pressure. It is the love of Christ. "Christ's love controls us... He died for all so that those who live would no longer live for themselves" (2 Corinthians 5:14-15, NASB).

Todd's Story

"For three years I wanted nothing more than to join the most popular group at my high school—the Mavericks. Even after becoming a Christian, I still thought it might be harmless, even though it was a drinking club.

I finally decided I needed to go all out for Christ. That same week I was invited to join the Mavericks. I immediately knew that the stakes were high, and that Satan was trying to derail my decision. Instead of giving in, I turned my life fully over to God. He gave me freedom I had not known before and a purpose that reached beyond myself."

A Simple Step of Surrender

Giving control of your life to the Holy Spirit is a decision of faith, just as receiving Christ was a decision of faith. You simply place yourself in the hands of a trustworthy God.

You might pray:

“Lord Jesus, I want my life to be directed by You rather than by self. I confess the ways I have lived independently of You. Holy Spirit, I ask You to take control of my life right now.”

Q: What does this kind of commitment mean to you?

Restoring Fellowship

At times, believers sin and break fellowship with the Holy Spirit (1 John 1:8). This does not mean your salvation is lost. Jesus paid for all your sins on the cross, once and for all. Broken fellowship means that you are not abiding in Christ. If it is not mended, you will not experience the abundant life Jesus promised and will begin to miss His purpose and plan for your life.

You can return and restore your fellowship with God at any moment. The way back is simple:

1. Yield yourself again to God.
2. Confess your specific sins
3. Trust the Spirit that He is in control.



Spiritual Breathing

Walking in the Spirit is a moment-by-moment dependence on Him. One helpful picture is what Bill Bright called “spiritual breathing.” Just as physical breathing involves exhaling what is harmful and inhaling what gives life, we “exhale” sin through honest confession and “inhale” the Spirit’s control by faith.

Whenever you become aware of sin or self-centeredness, you can turn quickly: confess it, and by faith entrust yourself again to the Spirit’s leadership. He is always ready to restore and empower you.

Go Deeper

[Who Is the Holy Spirit?](#)

4. Walking by Faith, Not by Feelings

God's power to live for Christ and walk in the Holy Spirit is available to us only through faith.

Q: What does Hebrews 11:6 say about faith?

Faith is a steadfast trust in God that results in action. Living for Christ is not trying to do what Jesus did in our own strength, but letting Him live His life through us by faith—trusting Jesus enough to do whatever He tells us to do, exactly as He wants it done.

As we live by faith, Jesus' love will shine through us. Genuine faith in Christ produces obedience to God's Word, the Bible, even though there will be ups and downs (James 2:17).

Your faith will be tested throughout life. Scripture describes the Christian life as a battlefield with three persistent enemies: the world, the flesh, and the devil. God has given us powerful means to overcome these enemies.

Q: Read Ephesians 6:10-18. What are the keys to winning this battle?

Overcoming Doubt

Joni's Story

Joni Eareckson was an active, athletic teenager until the day she dove into shallow water and broke her neck. In a moment, the future she had imagined was gone. She would never walk or use her hands again.

Although she had trusted Christ as a teenager, the months that followed her injury shook her deeply. "In those first few months," she later wrote, "the promises of God seemed anything but true... How could I be expected to believe when everything inside and outside of me screamed just the opposite?"

Through the steady encouragement of a friend and the truth of God's Word, Joni began to choose faith over her feelings. Looking back, she has said that her paralysis was not a cruel joke but was used by God's love. Today she leads an international ministry that shares the hope of Christ with people affected by disability.

Her life reminds us that victorious faith is not the absence of struggle. It is trusting God even when we cannot yet see the reason.

Victorious Faith

Hebrews 11 introduces us to men and women who trusted God despite great adversity, opposition, and even suffering. Faith in God always pleases God and results in a life of victory over any circumstance.

Read Hebrews 11 and note what stands out to you about those who walked by faith:

A life without faith, on the other hand, is disastrous for God's people.

God performed spectacular miracles to save the Israelites from slavery in Egypt—ten plagues in Egypt, the parting of the Red Sea, and daily provision in the wilderness. Yet they soon forgot and began to doubt His promise of a good land (Promised Land) and bright future (Read Exodus chapters 3 through 20).

When twelve spies of Israel were sent out to scout the Promised Land, they returned with a report that the land was "flowing with milk and honey," but occupied by giants. Only Joshua and Caleb were willing to move forward in faith. The rest of the people turned back in fear. As a result, that generation wandered for forty years in the wilderness, never to enter the rest God had prepared for them. (Read chapters 13 and 14 in the book of Numbers.)

Q: What “giants” in your life currently make trust difficult?

Q : Read Hebrews 3:7–4:16. According to this passage, how do we enter God’s rest?

Q: What does the passage warn us against?

God still promises rest to those who trust Him. Victorious faith is simply taking God at His Word and moving forward, even when circumstances or emotions suggest otherwise.

Examining Your Trust

What in your life keeps you from trusting God fully— Relationships, finances, plans, habits, past failures, thought life, fear, or the desire for control?

Ask God to reveal them to you. Write down any area God shows you and take it prayerfully back to God to help you change the way you think about it. Your faith will be strengthened when you first change your perspective and way of thinking.

“Don’t copy the behavior and customs of this world, but let God transform you into a new person by changing the way you think. Then you will learn to know God’s will for you, which is good and pleasing and perfect.” (Romans 12:2, NLT)

Go Deeper

Faith: Knowing Who You Can Trust

5. God's Word – Your Road Map

If you received a personal letter from Jesus telling you how much He loves you and offering clear direction for your daily life, would you read it carefully? Would you return to it often?

That is what the Bible is—God's own word to you. Just as a new baby needs milk to grow, you need God's Word to grow in your new life.

Before You Begin

Obtain a Bible with good references and helps. There are many English translations. You may find a modern translation easier to understand. Free online Bibles are available at sites such as bible.com in many languages.

God's Road Map for Your Life

If you were traveling to a place you had never been, would you rely only on instinct, or would you use a GPS or reliable map?

While the map will not show you every detail of your travel and what is along the road, it will keep you from heading in the wrong direction, giving you guidance for your trip.

The Bible provides the “road map” for your journey with God. It teaches you all the truth you need for your life.

Forming a New Habit

Most of what we do each day is out of habit. In order to make God's Word part of your life, you need to make it one of your daily habits. Choose a consistent time (many find mornings helpful) and a quiet place. Read a section of the Bible and ask God to show you what He wants you to understand and apply.

Like with any new habit, making God's Word part of your daily life will take time. Be patient and persistent. The more you let His Word dwell in you richly, the more you will experience God's presence and power in your life.

God's Viewpoint

The Bible gives you God's answers to the most important questions of life:

- Who God is
- Your purpose
- How to grow in Christ
- Moral decisions
- Relationships
- Peace and comfort in hardship
- Suffering and death

“For the word of God is living and active and sharper than any double-edged sword... it is able to judge the desires and thoughts of the heart.” (Hebrews 4:12)

What Fills Your Mind

Every day your mind is flooded with the voices and messages around you—most of them reflecting the world's perspective. What you allow to fill your mind will influence your decisions, attitudes, actions, and direction.

If God's perspective is to shape your life, you must give your regular time and serious effort to “feed on” His Word.

Matthew Henry once said: “If you want to get close to God, you must study His Word.”

Q: How does Colossians 3:16 speak to you personally?

Five Ways to Take in God's Word

1. Hearing God's Word

You can hear Scripture taught through:

- Local church gatherings
- Faithful Bible teachers
- Small groups and studies
- Trusted online resources
- Christian audiobooks

Q: In what ways are you currently hearing God's Word? How could you increase that?

Q: What does Acts 17:11 encourage us to do when we hear teaching?

When you hear God's Word taught, listen for what the Holy Spirit is trying to teach you personally. Taking good notes and writing down your thoughts will help you remember and apply His teaching.

2. Reading God's Word

Read slowly and thoughtfully. Keep a pen to underline or note what stands out. If you are new to the Bible, start with the Gospel of Mark or the Gospel of John. Then read the book of Acts that records the actions of the early Christians. The Gospel of Luke and Acts were both written by Luke and together give you key events in the first century from the birth of Jesus to the explosive growth of the church.

"All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness" (2 Timothy 3:16).

Q: Which book of the Bible are you currently reading? What is the Holy Spirit showing you?

3. Studying God's Word

Study can take different forms:

- An individual book
- A single chapter or passage
- A theme (such as love, forgiveness, or faith)
- A key verse
- A central truth of the faith

The goal is not information alone, but insight into who God is and what He wants to do in your life.

One simple way to study is to read a short passage slowly, then ask: What does this show me about God? About myself? About how I am to live? Write down what you notice.

Q: Read 2 Corinthians 5:14-17 in one or two translations. What does this passage mean to you?

4. Memorizing God's Word

Hiding Scripture in your heart gives you truth to carry into every situation. Begin with a few key verses. Write them on small cards, review them regularly, and speak them aloud. Over time, they become part of your inner vocabulary.

"I have hidden your word in my heart that I might not sin against you." (Psalm 119:11).

5. Meditating on God's Word

Meditation is simply turning a truth over in your mind throughout the day. When stress, temptation, or uncertainty arises, bring a relevant verse to mind and let it steady you.

Q: What does Philippians 4:6-7 offer in moments of anxiety?

The Power of God's Word to Transform

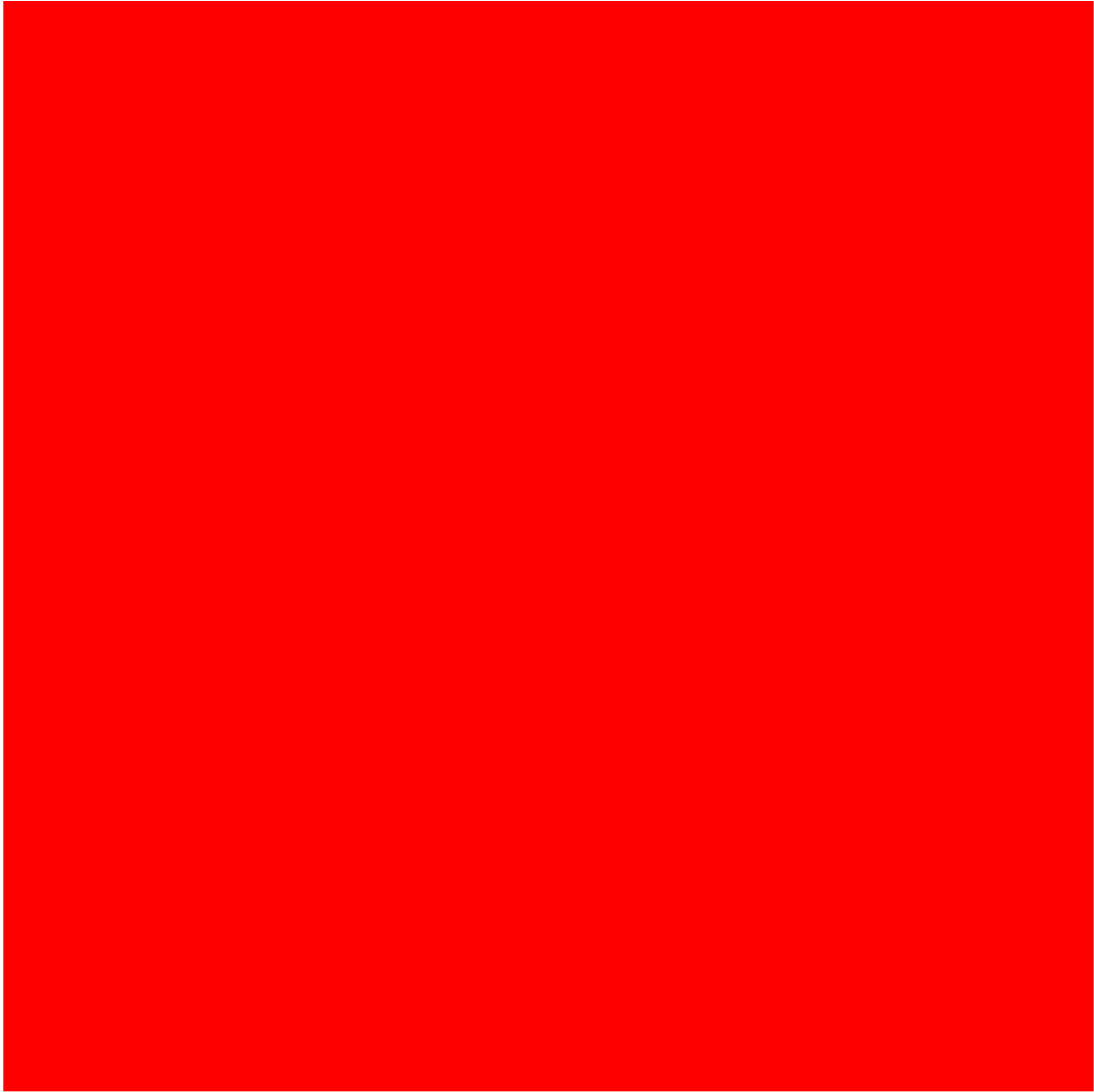
In the late 1970s, David Berkowitz—known as the “Son of Sam”—was imprisoned after a series of murders in New York. While in prison, he was given a Bible. As he read, the Word of God began to confront and change him. In time, he turned to Christ in genuine repentance. Today he serves as a chaplain's assistant, a living example of how Scripture can break old patterns and create a new life.

Transformation happens as the world's perspective is gradually replaced by God's. The amount of time you commit to the Bible is probably the single best indicator of your walk with Christ, and the best predictor of your future growth in Christ.

“Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly” (Colossians 3:16).

Q: Read Psalm 1:1-3. What picture does it give of a life rooted in God's Word?

As you continue walking with Jesus, let His Word become the steady foundation of your life.



Go Deeper

Renewing the Mind for Transformation